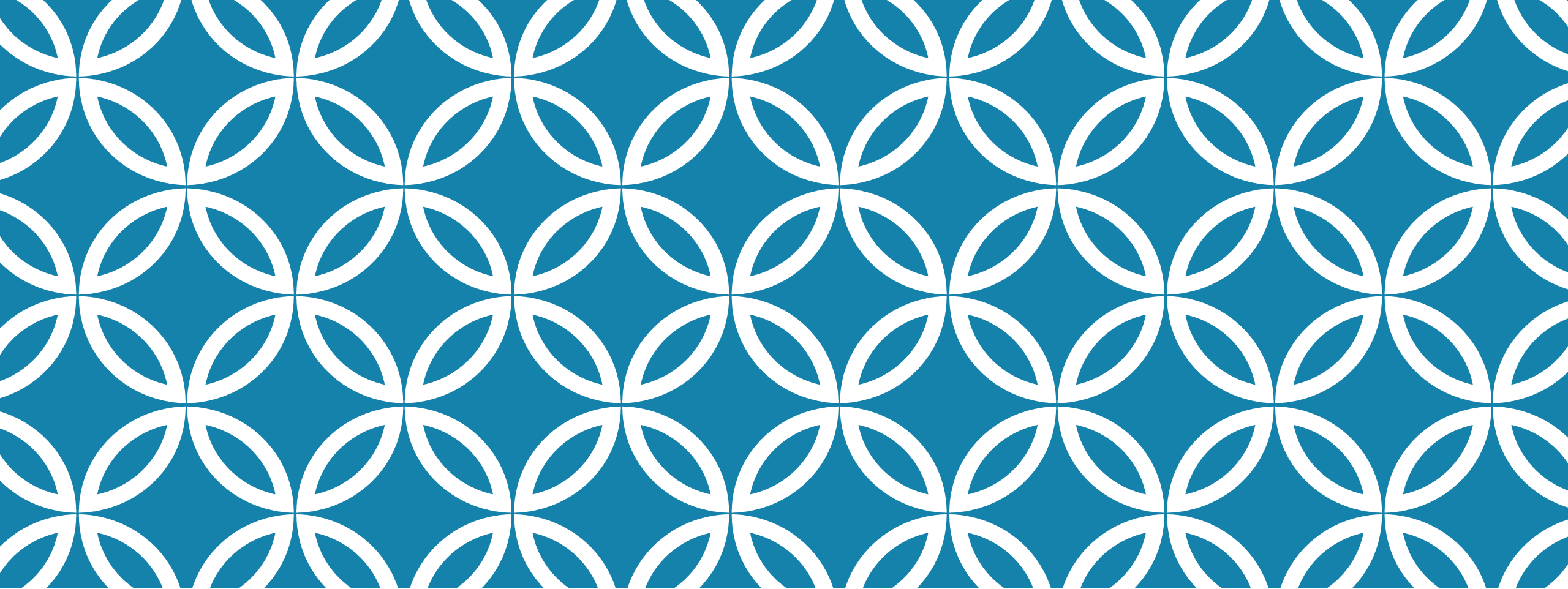




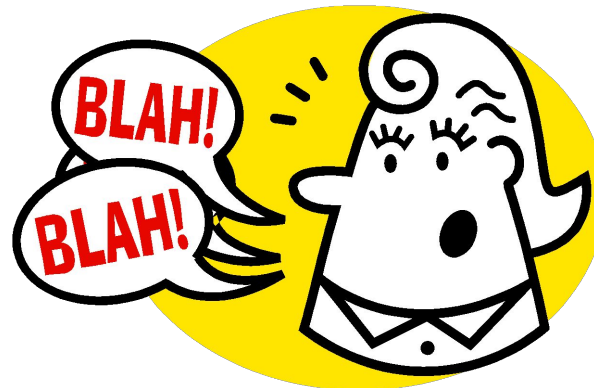
RHETORICAL QUESTIONS

WHAT DOES RHETORICAL MEAN?

‘Rhetorical’ comes from the word ‘rhetoric’ – which is a special kind of talking

‘Rhetoric’ is used to persuade or influence people, in other words, to change their minds

We often see Rhetorical Questions in a debate because in a debate we want to change people’s minds



HOW TO LOOK FOR A RHETORICAL QUESTION

A Rhetorical Question is a question that does NOT need to be answered.

Q & ~~A~~

WHY DO WE USE RHETORICAL QUESTIONS?

Because the answer is obvious

"Do you want extra homework?"



WHY DO WE USE RHETORICAL QUESTIONS?

.....maybe to make people think of something they might not have thought about yet

“What would happen to us if we didn’t have doctors?”



WHY DO WE USE RHETORICAL QUESTIONS?

Sometimes a rhetorical question is really just a different way of saying a sentence

“Don’t you want to help your mother?”

(Come & help!)



WHY DO WE USE RHETORICAL QUESTIONS?

Sometimes people ask a question and then answer it straight away (a bit like talking to themselves)

“Is chocolate good for you? No it isn’t, but we all need something as a treat sometimes.”



HOW TO TELL IF A QUESTION IS RHETORICAL

Think: does the person asking the question *really* want to know some new information from me?

If the answer is **no**, it is probably a rhetorical question.

Q & ~~A~~

SPOT THE DIFFERENCE

Do you want sugar in your coffee?

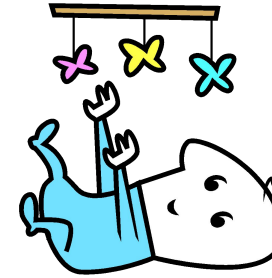
Are they ever going to get here?

What's the price of this T-shirt?

Really, you're crying about it?

Are you two years old or something?

Are you hungry?



SPOT THE DIFFERENCE

Do you want sugar in your coffee?

X

Are they ever going to get here?

R

What's the price of this T-shirt?

X

Really, you're crying about it?

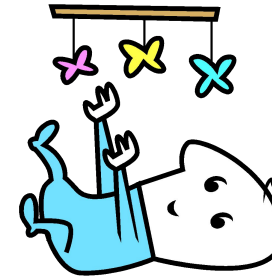
R

Are you two years old or something?

R

Are you hungry?

X



NOW YOU TRY



QUICK DEBATE:

“Should mobile phones be allowed in school?”

Think of a rhetorical question **FOR** this argument

Think of a rhetorical question **AGAINST** this argument

FOR:

Who wouldn't want to watch movies on their phones during a boring lesson?



AGAINST:

How could you make friends if everyone has their head stuck in a phone all day?



If TV's so
bad for you,
why is there
one in every
hospital room?



Looking for a new diet? Try a high-fibre diet!

The population is “not eating enough fruit, vegetables, oily fish and fibre” according to the Government’s National Diet and Nutrition Survey ¹

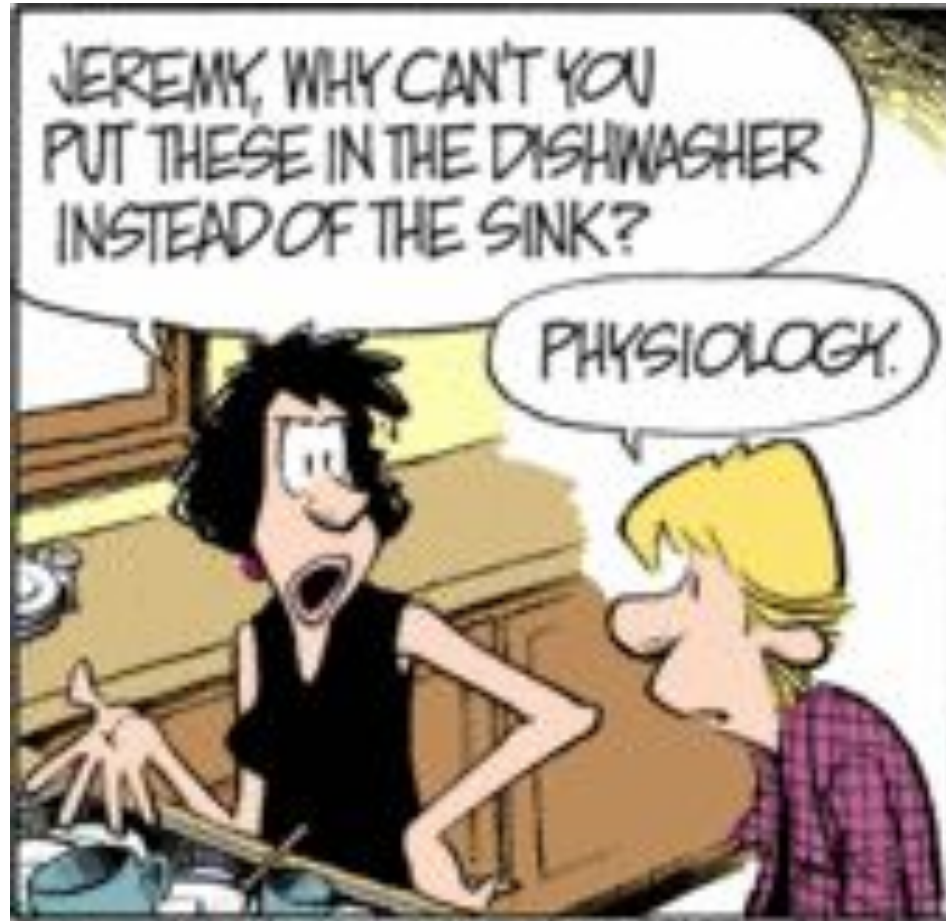


Health benefits of a high-fibre diet: ²

- Lowers cholesterol and blood pressure
- Reduces risk of
 - Coronary heart disease
 - Stroke
 - Diabetes
 - Obesity

¹ Public Health England. (2014)

² Anderson, J. W., Baird, P., Davis, R. H., Ferreri, S., Knudtson, M., Koraym, A., Waters, V., & Williams, C. L. (2009). Health benefits of dietary fiber, *Nutrition Reviews*, 67, 188-205.

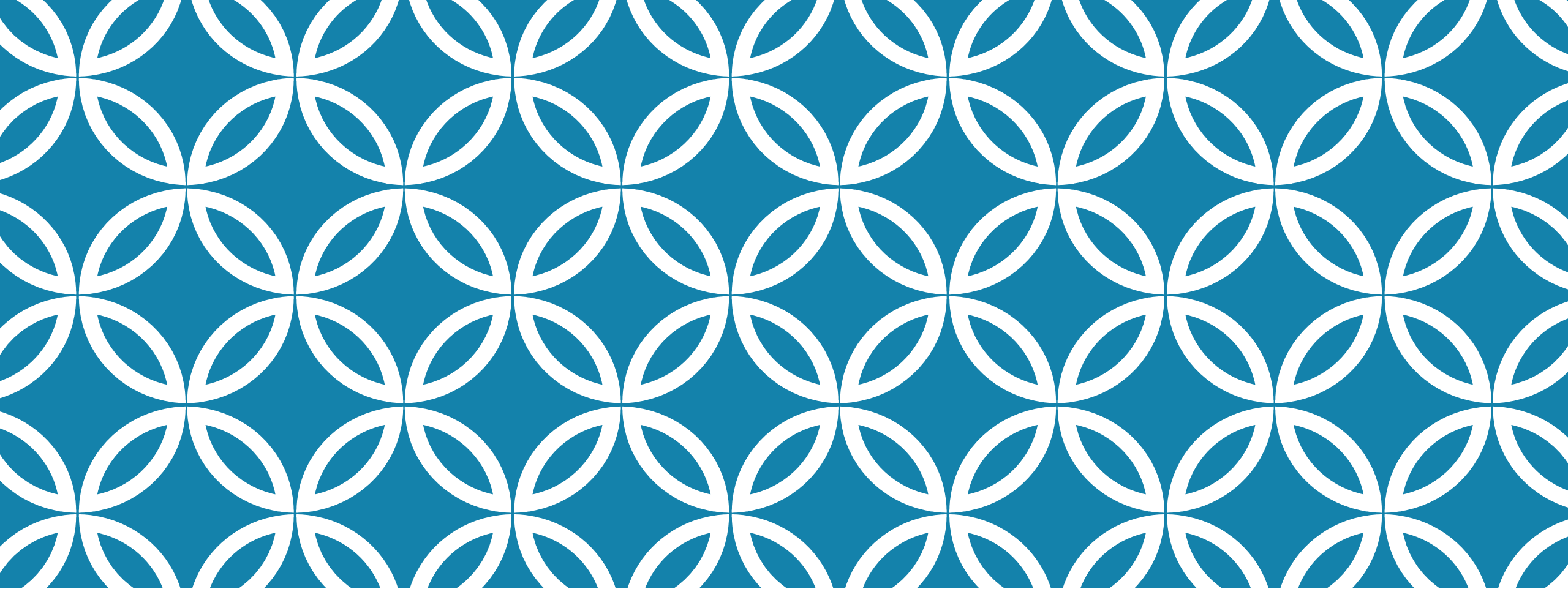


Me and
???????

J J



**I CAN MAKE IT
TO THE GATE
IN 3 SECONDS
CAN YOU?**



TESTS TO 'TEST' YOUR RHETORICAL QUESTIONS



TESTS TO ‘TEST’ YOUR RHETORICAL QUESTION

1. Purpose Test

Ask: Does this question make readers think or emphasize an idea (not expect an answer)?

Effective: “Can a nation progress without education?”
Makes readers reflect on the value of education.

Ineffective: “Do you know the answer to this question?”
Expects a real response — not rhetorical or thought-provoking.

2. Implied Answer Test

Ask: Is the answer clearly understood without saying it?

Effective: “Who doesn’t want peace?”
The answer is obvious — *everyone does*.

Ineffective: “Who wants peace?” The answer isn’t implied — it sounds like a genuine question.

3. Structure & Relevance Test

Ask: Is it grammatically correct and connected to your topic?

Effective: “Isn’t it time we acted on climate change?”

Grammatically correct and directly linked to the issue.

Ineffective: “Is not it time act we on change?”

Grammatically incorrect and confusing.